

Dr. Sanjay Chugh

■ INDICATIONS FOR rTMS

After undergoing intensive training at the Harvard Medical School & Medical University of South Carolina, Dr. Chugh set up the facility for clinical delivery of rTMS. Dr. Chugh's clinic in Delhi is a part of the Global Clinical Trials Network of the Harvard Medical School for rTMS. Different centres worldwide have used this treatment in a vast multitude of disorders. The list given below is by no means exhaustive and according to Dr. Chugh, it is worthwhile exploring this Non-Invasive Brain Stimulation technique in most forms of chronic, non-responsive medical as well as psychiatric disorders. rTMS has been used as a treatment for PSYCHIATRIC DISORDERS like Depression, Schizophrenia, Bipolar Disorder, Addictions, Anxiety, Post-traumatic Stress Disorder, Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder, Panic Disorder, Phobias, ADHD and Eating Disorders. The NEUROLOGICAL DISORDERS for which rTMS has shown good results are Migraine, Stroke Rehabilitation, Parkinsonism, Trigeminal Neuralgia, Multiple Sclerosis, Tinnitus, Autism, Tourette's Syndrome, Fibromyalgia, Chronic Pain and Spasticity due to various aetiologies. In OPTHALMOLOGY, rTMS has proven useful in Lazy Eye or Amblyopia.

■ Deafness Not a Handicap: "Cochlear Implants"



Dr K Malik

Cochlear Implants (CIs) are one of the most magnificent marvels achieved by medical science in the last century. With the advent of these a vast number of hearing impaired have reclaimed their hearing and are leading a sound-full life. Dr Kshitij Malik, (MBBS, Mast Audvest.. Medicine) who chairs the cochlear implant program at "Prime Speech & Hearing Clinic, Delhi" (www.primehearing.com) informs us that CIs are surgically implantable devices which provide sound detection and speech recognition to people who receive little or no benefit from hearing aids. However, strict criteria define who can, and cannot

LATEST TREATMENT FOR PSYCHIATRIC & NEUROLOGICAL DISORDERS REPETITIVE TRANSCRANIAL MAGNETIC STIMULATION (rTMS)

- BY M.V.SESHADRI

According to Dr. Sanjay Chugh, Delhi based Neuropsychiatrist, who has recently introduced rTMS in India after training in the US and England, this treatment is being referred to globally as the most important advance in the field of neuropsychiatry in the last 50 years. It involves the use of an electromagnet to noninvasively stimulate specific areas of the brain of a patient to elicit a therapeutic response. It is being used in several countries in the world already. rTMS has the ability to selectively modulate or change activity in small areas of the brain. It is used to elicit certain desired effects, either excitatory or inhibitory, that have shown efficacy in treating various conditions or illnesses. The magnetic field is generated by passing brief current pulses through a hand held, figure of 8 coil placed over the head.



Giving details of the use of rTMS in certain disorders, Dr. Chugh says that Drug resistance, or refractory depression, occurs in up to 30% of cases. It is in these cases that rTMS presents the possibility for greatest benefit. Some have called TMS a "life saver."

Most patients with schizophrenia experience auditory hallucinations. With rTMS, a majority of patients showed significant reduction in their voices. Negative symptoms also respond well to rTMS. In OCD & Tourette's Disorder also, significant reduction has been seen in the various symptoms. The same is seen with other anxiety disorders as well.

Stroke victims regained motor performance and accuracy more readily when their motor cortices were magnetically stimulated with rTMS. rTMS sessions appear to have a cumulative benefit for improving gait, as well as reducing upper limb slowness in Parkinsonism.

In Multiple Sclerosis, changes are seen in spasticity & in urinary tract dysfunction. In Migraine, rTMS plays an important preventive role as well.

The treatment runs over 20 to 30 sessions of 30 minutes each, given once or twice daily. rTMS can be given along with any other medications that the patient is already taking. Once improvement starts, the requirement for medicines starts to come down, decreasing the side effects produced by medicines & improving the compliance.

rTMS is a very safe procedure and is generally free from side effects when proper procedures are followed. Local discomfort, headache and ringing in the ears caused by the noise of the stimulating coil are minor problems that may be encountered. No long-term risks of rTMS are reported. In pregnancy, the risk to a fetus from rTMS applied to the brain of a mother is almost certainly less than that with medication.

For further details about all these modalities, contact Dr. Chugh's clinic in New Delhi on +919811079401 / 011-41436012 / 011-29219746
Email id: doc@drchugh.com • Website: www.rtms.co.in



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- Dr. Kshitij Malik
(MBBS, MS)
Audiovestibular Physician
(UCL, London)

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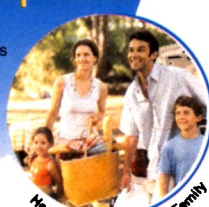
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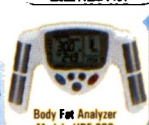
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